

Musamman Burj (Octagonal Tower / "Shah Burj")

مٹمن برج

1. Basic Facts

- Built by: Not separately documented from the wider Shah Burj Quadrangle building programme
- Built in: Shah Jahan's reign
- Cost: Not documented
- Built for: An octagonal corner tower that gives the wider quadrangle its name

2. Construction Details

- Form: Octagonal (eight-sided) tower structure at a corner of the Shah Burj Quadrangle
- Materials/technique: Not separately documented

3. Historical Background

- Maharaja Ranjit Singh specifically chose this tower, alongside the adjoining Sheesh Mahal chambers within it, for his own private and official use during the Sikh period - out of the entire fort, this corner is where the most powerful man in Punjab chose to work.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- The tower's name directly gives the wider Shah Burj Quadrangle its identity - "Shah Burj" literally means "royal tower," and this octagonal structure is the tower the name refers to.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

An eight-sided tower at the corner of a Mughal empress's private quarters becomes, two centuries later, the office of a Sikh Maharaja - the same walls witnessing two entirely different courts, two entirely different languages of power, without ever being rebuilt.